

ROLE PLAYING FANTASIES

Violent Wanderings

Rape. It's a violent word that takes away consent from a woman's dictionary. Yet, of the respondents who said they fantasised about role playing, 25 per cent said they fantasised about raping their partner and 19 per cent said they pretended they were getting raped. Amongst those who said they indulged in role playing, 14 per cent said they had tried pretending to rape their partner while 13 per cent said they had pretended to be raped by their partner. On the surface, it does seem like the politics of power has moved from the boardroom into the bedroom, from the public to the private. But Western writers coin a different term for this. They call it

ravishment, a BDSM scenario that removes the violence and non-consent associated with the word rape. And like Nancy Friday says, in her 1973 book, *The Secret Garden*, "The most popular guilt-avoiding device was the so-called rape fantasy. Saying she was 'raped' was the most expedient way of getting past the big No to sex that had been imprinted on the woman's mind since early childhood." But, what of the Indian male? Sociologist Patricia Uberoi points out that the survey indicates that the Indian male seems quite convinced that they are being raped, pointing perhaps to the high value ascribed to asceticism in our philosophy. **by Chitra Subramanyam**

What kind of role play do you fantasise about?

TOP 5 FOR MEN

Acting as a stranger to your partner	27
Teacher-student scenario where you are the teacher	21
Hotel waiter scenario	21
Acting as a private dancer	16
Doctor-nurse scenario	15

TOP 5 FOR WOMEN

Acting a stranger to your partner	23
Air hostess/cabin crew scenario	16
Acting as a private dancer	15
Office co-worker scenario	14
Teacher-student scenario	11

For 883 respondents of the total 5,371 who have fantasised about role playing. Figures don't add up to 100 because of multiple choices. All figures in per cent.

Model ANKUSH/Orange Model Management Location courtesy THE PARK, NEW DELHI



What kind of sexual activities have you indulged in with your partner?

Anal sex	41
Masturbation by your partner	35
Position 69	23
Oral sex	55

For 4,222 respondents of the total 5,371 who have had sex. Figures add up to more than 100 because of multiple choices. All figures in per cent.

gauging cultural and social attitudes. For, by asking a specific question, it also says 'this question is important', thereby creating a sense of the world that may not have earlier existed. Second, current contexts of globalisation and consumerist modernity are important ones when we think about sex. For, now, more than ever, the idea of a 'world of choices' operates as a significant variable in our lives. This is a context where Indian sexual cultures are slowly but surely moving beyond the 'family planning' gaze of the Five-Year Plan state to the sex-as-leisure domains of the market.

The idea of sex-as-leisure (as distinct from reproductive sex) is fundamental to the survey questions that were grouped under the heading of fetish. So, this perhaps is one of the most significant changes in contemporary Indian society: the willingness of middle-class women and men to conceive of a world beyond conception, and a life beyond sexual-nationalism. It is perhaps yearnings for these new worlds that are reflected in responses to questions regarding fantasies of role play during sex. So, while 90 per cent of all women surveyed said that they had never participated in role playing while having sex, 23 per cent responded that they fantasised about the role play of acting as a stranger to their partner. Similarly, while 81 per cent of all men